STUDENT WORKSHEET #2

Real-World Health Myth Breakdown

Case Study: Hyper-Realistic AI Wellness Influencer Ads

Student Name: _____ **Date:** _____ **Class Period:** _____

1. Case Study: The AI Wellness Avatar

Viral Ad Scenario:

A social media video features a realistic avatar wearing a white lab coat with a stethoscope. The speaker claims: *"I'm a chief cardiothoracic researcher, and modern medicine doesn't want you to know that drinking this target extract removes 90% of arterial plaque in 7 days. Click link in bio before this video is taken down!"*

Visual Elements: Stock lab background, urgent countdown timer, simulated customer reviews showing instant weight loss.

2. The Red Flag Checklist

Check off all manipulation markers present in this case study:

- [x] **Emotional Urgency / Censorship Threat:** Claims video is about to be taken down to panic viewers.
- [x] **Authority Costume (Visual Manipulation):** White coat and stethoscope without real institutional badge/credentials.
- [x] **Conspiracy Narrative:** Uses "doctors don't want you to know" to undermine established science.
- [x] **Unrealistic Claims:** Promises impossible 90% plaque removal in 7 days without clinical trial proof.

3. Small-Group Discussion Questions

Discuss in groups of 3-4 and record your key points:

1. Why might someone scrolling on social media quickly fall for this avatar?

2. How does the realistic AI voice generator increase trust compared to a text post?

3. What steps can you take to protect family members who might believe these video ads?

4. Action Plan: How to Report Misinformation

3 Actions to Take When You Spot Fake AI Health Ads:

1. **Do Not Engagement-Bait:** Commenting or sharing increases the ad's algorithmic reach.
2. **Report for Health Misinformation:** Use platform reporting tools to flag false medical claims.
3. **Verify Before Warning:** Use verification platforms to confirm facts before posting counters.